

# Daily Bible Note

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Date: August 31, 2026

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## I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 48:23–35

23 “As for the rest of the tribes, from the east side to the west, Benjamin shall have one section;

24 by the border of Benjamin, from the east side to the west, Simeon shall have one section;

25 by the border of Simeon, from the east side to the west, Issachar shall have one section;

26 by the border of Issachar, from the east side to the west, Zebulun shall have one section;

27 by the border of Zebulun, from the east side to the west, Gad shall have one section;

28 by the border of Gad, on the south side, toward the South, the border shall be from Tamar to the waters of Meribah by Kadesh, along the brook to the Great Sea.

29 This is the land which you shall divide by lot as an inheritance among the tribes of Israel, and these are their portions,” says the Lord God.

30 “These are the exits of the city. On the north side, measuring four thousand five hundred cubits

31 (the gates of the city shall be named after the tribes of Israel), the three gates northward: one gate for Reuben, one gate for Judah, and one gate for Levi;

32 on the east side, four thousand five hundred cubits, three gates: one gate for Joseph, one gate for Benjamin, and one gate for Dan;

33 on the south side, measuring four thousand five hundred cubits, three gates: one gate for Simeon, one gate for Issachar, and one gate for Zebulun;

34 on the west side, four thousand five hundred cubits with their three gates: one gate for Gad, one gate for Asher, and one gate for Naphtali.

35 All the way around shall be eighteen thousand cubits; and the name of the city from that day shall be: THE LORD IS THERE.”

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## II. Key Summary

- Five tribes — Benjamin, Simeon, Issachar, Zebulun, and Gad — each receive one section running from the east side to the west; Gad's southern border runs from Tamar to the waters of Meribah by Kadesh, along the brook to the Great Sea.
  - Each side of the city measures four thousand five hundred cubits and has three gates, twelve in all, each named after a tribe of Israel: Reuben, Judah, and Levi on the north; Joseph, Benjamin, and Dan on the east; Simeon, Issachar, and Zebulun on the south; Gad, Asher, and Naphtali on the west.
  - All the way around, the city measures eighteen thousand cubits, and from that day its name shall be THE LORD IS THERE.
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## III. Passage Analysis

Every tribe has its own gate

Because the city was to be served out of all the tribes of Israel, it was fit that each tribe should have its gate... Into the church of Christ there is a free access by faith for all that come of every tribe, from every quarter. [1]

Levi received no land portion of its own, and Joseph's two sons are counted as a single gate, which is how the number twelve is filled out with three gates on each side. Having your name written on a gate says plainly that no tribe has to take the long way around to get in.

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The name of the city shall be THE LORD IS THERE

Ezekiel experienced the horror of seeing the glory of God departing from the temple in a vision. Then he saw it return. Now, in the new name for the city, he received the assurance that God would remain. [2]

Ezekiel opens with a vision of God's glory, and its final line rests on "THE LORD IS THERE."

What gives this city its weight is that God lives inside it and does not leave again.

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#### IV. Reflection Question

What do you think would make God leave you?

Ezekiel watched God's glory leave the temple, and still heard the city named "THE LORD IS THERE" — staying is God's own decision, and his promise is to be with us always, to the end of the age.

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#### References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Commentary,

[https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Eze/Eze\\_048.cfm](https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_048.cfm)

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-48/>